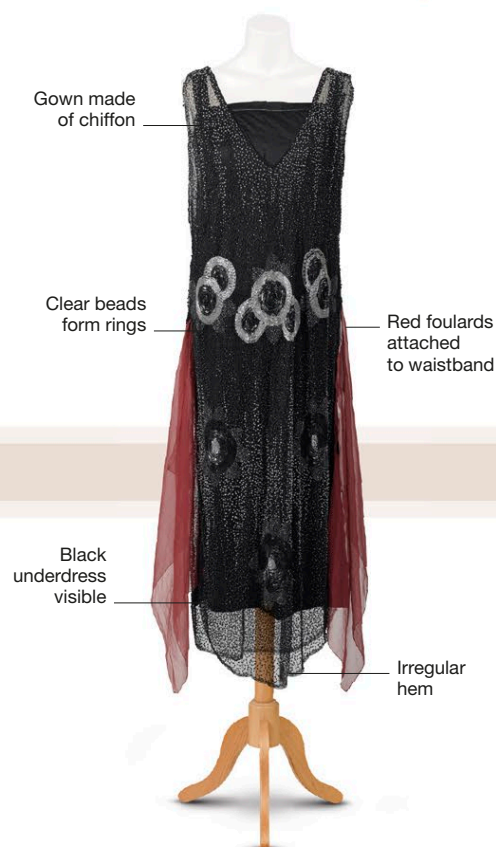




Slip-on Most evening gowns in the 1920s did not have any fastenings and were just slipped on. This dress is embroidered all over in gold. Its peach-coloured chiffon lining is used as a decorative feature and shines through below the waist.



Egyptian style Popular interest in archaeology led to the use of shapes and colours that were inspired by artefacts and imagery of ancient cultures. The architectural nature of the embroidery here would have given the wearer a statuesque air.

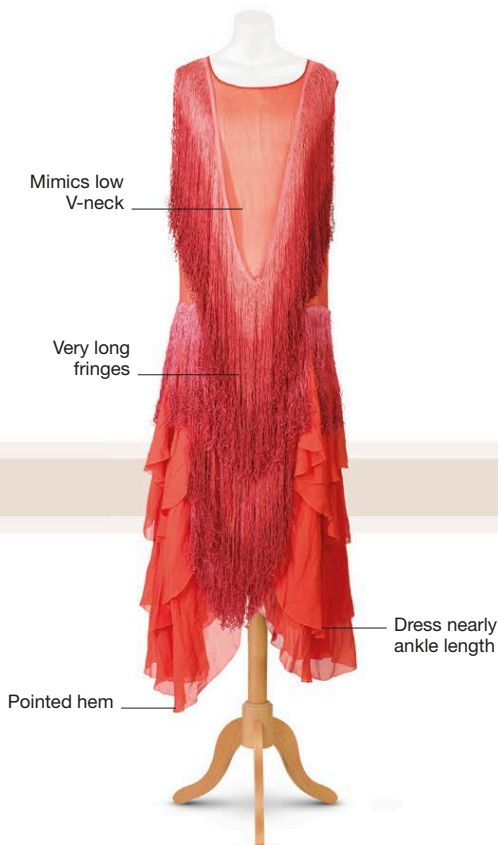


Beadwork This transparent chiffon gown is embroidered with black and clear beads. The black underdress, visible underneath, has narrow shoulder straps. Foulards (scarves) of red gauzy material attached to the waist soften the straight silhouette.



1928

Glow worm The name given to this design, *Ver Luisant* (glow worm), might allude to the iridescent beads with which it is covered. The top is embroidered with beads in vertical lines that give way to swirls below the waist, finishing in a fringed sash.



Shades of red This bright red chiffon gown has several rows of deep flounces below the hips. It is decorated with layers of two types of deep fringing in lighter to darker shades of pink and coral.

STRAP PUMPS

Evening frocks were worn with closed sandals or strap pumps in a variety of materials, including fabric and metallic leathers. The quest for decoration and ornament extended to shoes: leather was tooled (stamped or painted), and fabric was embroidered with beads, spangles, and rhinestones. Some manufacturers even offered separate heels ornamented with diamanté that were laid in geometric shapes into a celluloid base imitating mother-of-pearl. These heels could be attached to different pairs of shoes.

